

# The Fire and the Dream

The Civil Rights Movement & the Era of Movements · 1954–1975 | Standards US.78, US.79, US.80, US.81, US.82

Name \_\_\_\_\_

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

## ESSENTIAL QUESTION

For a century after slavery ended, America had written 'liberty and justice for all' on paper and then denied it, in law, to millions of its own people. This unit is about the generation that finally forced the country to keep its word — not by waiting, but by marching, sitting in, riding buses, and being willing to bleed for it. How does a people with almost no power move a whole nation? And once one group pries the door open, who walks through it next?

*Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.*

## 1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

segregation \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

nonviolent direct action \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Civil Rights Act of 1964 \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Black nationalism \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Brown v. Board of Education \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

sit-in \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Voting Rights Act of 1965 \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

the movements \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

## 2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

| # | What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Your read & evidence |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1 | <p>Analyze Brown v. Board of Education and the fierce, sometimes violent struggle to enforce school desegregation.</p> <p><b>Notice:</b> Nine words on a courtroom wall: 'Equal Justice Under Law.' For sixty years, the Supreme Court had said segregation was just fine — 'separate but...</p> <p><b>Debrief:</b> Explain what Brown v. Board of Education decided and why it mattered. Then explain why the ruling was so hard to enforce, using Little Rock or the Clinton 12 as evidence.</p>                                                                                                           |                      |
| 2 | <p>Compare the different strategies civil-rights advocates used — legal challenges, nonviolence, and self-determination.</p> <p><b>Notice:</b> You and your friends all want the same thing — justice — but you can't agree on how to get it. One says work through the courts, patiently, case...</p> <p><b>Debrief:</b> Compare the strategies of Thurgood Marshall, Martin Luther King Jr., and Malcolm X. What could each accomplish that the others could not? Why might a movement benefit from having more than one strategy?</p>                                                                     |                      |
| 3 | <p>Analyze how the Montgomery Bus Boycott and the student sit-ins used disciplined nonviolent action to break segregation — with Nashville as a...</p> <p><b>Notice:</b> A tired seamstress refuses to give up her seat, and a whole city stops riding the buses for a year. College students dress in their Sunday best...</p> <p><b>Debrief:</b> Explain how the Montgomery Bus Boycott and the sit-ins each used nonviolent tactics to fight segregation. Why did refusing to fight back make these protests so effective? What made Nashville's campaign a model?</p>                                    |                      |
| 4 | <p>Analyze how the Freedom Rides and the March on Washington used courage and mass action to force the nation to confront segregation.</p> <p><b>Notice:</b> Get on a bus, ride it into the Deep South, and dare the mob to stop you. That's what the Freedom Riders did — Black and white activists riding...</p> <p><b>Debrief:</b> Explain what the Freedom Rides were and how Nashville students kept them going. Then explain the significance of the March on Washington. How did facing violence actually help the movement win support?</p>                                                          |                      |
| 5 | <p>Analyze the great civil-rights laws — the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 — and the Selma campaign that forced them.</p> <p><b>Notice:</b> Marches and speeches can change hearts, but only a law can change the rules. After a decade of boycotts, sit-ins, beatings, and dreams, the...</p> <p><b>Debrief:</b> Explain how the Selma marches led to the Voting Rights Act of 1965. Then describe what the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 each did. Why were laws necessary, not just protests?</p>                                               |                      |
| 6 | <p>Analyze the movement's later phase and its cost through the 1968 Memphis sanitation strike and the assassination of Martin Luther King Jr.</p> <p><b>Notice:</b> Two words on a sign, held by exhausted men who cleaned a city's garbage for poverty wages: 'I Am a Man.' In 1968, Memphis sanitation workers went...</p> <p><b>Debrief:</b> Explain what the Memphis sanitation strike was about and why 'I Am a Man' captured the movement's next goal. Then explain the significance of King's assassination there. What does Memphis 1968 show about the movement's cost and its unfinished work?</p> |                      |
| 7 | <p>Analyze the related equality movements the civil-rights movement inspired — the American Indian, Chicano/farmworker, and women's movements.</p> <p><b>Notice:</b> When one group forces a door open, others walk through it. The Black freedom movement didn't just win rights for Black Americans — it handed every...</p> <p><b>Debrief:</b> Describe the American Indian, Chicano/farmworker, and women's movements, giving one leader or event for each. Explain how they were inspired by the Black civil-rights movement — and why each was also its own distinct struggle.</p>                     |                      |

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 9 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **U.S. Army soldiers of the 101st Airborne escort one of the Little Rock Nine to Central High School in 1957, after the governor tried to block integration.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is the 101st Airborne escorting one of the Little Rock Nine into school in 1957 — U.S. soldiers protecting Black teenagers from other...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

| Year | Milestone                                   | Toward ↗ or away ↘? | Why — your evidence |
|------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| 1954 | Brown v. Board of Education                 |                     |                     |
| 1956 | The Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeds         |                     |                     |
| 1961 | The Freedom Rides face the fire             |                     |                     |
| 1964 | The Civil Rights Act of 1964                |                     |                     |
| 1965 | The Voting Rights Act of 1965               |                     |                     |
| 1968 | The assassination of Martin Luther King Jr. |                     |                     |
| 1968 | The movement inspires new movements         |                     |                     |

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This is the unit where the 'more perfect union' stops being a hope and becomes a demand. For nine units you've watched the gap between America's...

**Closing question:** The civil-rights movement forced America closer to its founding promise than any moment since Reconstruction — at a terrible cost, and with the work still unfinished. Choose one victory and one thing left undone, and argue how much closer the movement brought the country to 'liberty and justice for all.' Then explain how one later movement (women's, farmworkers', or Native) built on what it started. Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now: